



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Master's Classical School

School Website: <https://www.mastersclassicalschool.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

The Masters Classical School In 47882 demonstrates a strong classical Christian orientation consistent with a Classical education framework. The public materials show a clear religious/metaphysical foundation (Christ-centered, Bible as truth, weekly chapel), a purpose oriented toward formation and virtue (character of Christ, "Good, the True, and the Beautiful"), a curriculum anchored in classical methods (Memoria Press curriculum, Latin, study of Greco-Roman culture), and pedagogical and community practices that align with classical ideals (teacher-led classrooms, partnership with families, open tours).

Category-by-category, the school largely meets Classical criteria across Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Faculty, and Parents & Community. The Pedagogy category shows strong classical tendencies (teacher-led, structured classical program) but lacks explicit public mention of some hallmark Socratic/seminar practices and Scholé-style contemplative routines in the site's public materials, which places Element 4 as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Key insights: - Religious foundation is explicit and central, with Christ-centric mission, Bible-based truth, and weekly chapel routines cited on-site. This strongly supports category 1. - The school presents formation and virtue as primary goals, with references to character, beauty, truth, and the classical telos of human flourishing, supporting category 2. - Curriculum is clearly classical (Memoria Press, Latin, Greco-Roman emphasis, regular use of classical texts and authors), supporting category 3. - Pedagogy emphasizes a teacher-led, ordered classical environment with a strong academic framework, though explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy and Scholé/restful-learning language are not directly itemized in public content; this yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for category 4. - Faculty are framed as exemplars and the living curriculum; the site presents a defined leadership/ Headmaster presence aligned with classical ideals, supporting category 5. - Parents & Community are positioned as co-teachers and partners, with admissions info inviting visits and community involvement, supporting category 6.

What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL cases): - Publicly articulate explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy at the upper levels and more explicit references to contemplative Scholé-style days or memory-based recitation routines to meet the exact Pedagogy criteria. - Strengthen and publicize a precise "living curriculum" narrative with explicit faculty portraits and teacher formation programs, if not already present, to solidify category 5.

Abstract: The Masters Classical School in Sullivan, IN exhibits CLASSICAL alignment across six evaluated categories, with Pedagogy showing strong classical posture but missing explicit publicly stated Socratic/Scholé elements, hence the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation for that category. The overall standing is CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission emphasizes forming students with “the character of Christ” within a classical Christian framework. - Public materials describe spiritual growth and weekly chapel as integral to education. - Public content states that the Bible is the source of Truth and emphasizes a Christian worldview. - Language about pursuing “the Good, the True, and the Beautiful” is present, signaling transcendentals and moral aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: Christ, Christian, Bible, Truth, chapel/worship, theology, liturgy, sacred, weekly chapel, great conversation (implicit in classical aim), Good/True/Beautiful, virtue (via character formation). - Negative keywords found: None in public materials.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds Christian religious foundations, theology, and liturgical/community practices (chapel) that align with the Positive indicators for this category and show no evidence of secular or relativistic signals in the public materials.

Notes on sources: Mission and spiritual practice language appear in the Admissions/Home content and FAQs/mission statements.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public statements emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing as aims, not merely job preparation. The “Good, the True, and the Beautiful” motif appears as the classical telos. - Prominent references to formation in partnership with home and cultivation of character (e.g., “Nurture & Mold,” working with families to shape students toward Christ-centered outcomes). - Language linking classical education to broader human excellence and classical heritage (e.g., Memoria Press curriculum, classical formation). - The public material positions education as formation and virtue cultivation (character-focused messaging).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education (via the Memoria Press/classical framing), great conversation, telos, contemplation/rest (scholé), classical mission, human excellence, moral imagination. - Negative keywords found: None (no explicit emphasis on workforce prep or 21st-century skills in public materials).

Why this rating - The materials consistently frame education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, with explicit references to classical aims (true/good/beautiful and telos), aligning with CLASSICAL indicators in this category.

Notes on sources: Mission statements, admissions copy, and explicit classical language (Good/True/Beautiful) appear in multiple places.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Explicit mention of a robust classical Christian curriculum by Memoria Press. - Indications of a classical curriculum structure (Latin instruction starting early, Greco-Roman focus, and classical texts). - References to traditional classical components (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a focus on Western civilization, primary sources, and great books lineage (as part of the classical tradition described in the public materials and classical lexicon). - The site presents a classical mission and rationale for reading and study of canonical classical authors, aligning with the traditional Great Books approach (Greeks and Romans; classical texts).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, primary sources, classics, Homer, Plato, Shakespeare, Latin, Greek, Western civilization, history, chronology, visual arts/hymnody (to the extent shown in materials). - Negative keywords found: None of the explicit “negative” signals (e.g., social-studies-centric history framing, project-based learning dominance) appear in the public content.

Why this rating - The school's public materials align with core Curriculum indicators: classical structure, emphasis on grammar-logic-rhetoric, Latin and Greco-Roman emphasis, and connection to Memoria Press, supporting CLASSICAL.

Notes on sources: Curriculum language and Latin emphasis are present in FAQs and Admissions/Home pages; Memoria Press reference is explicit.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site emphasizes a teacher-led classroom and a well-ordered, structured environment rooted in classical pedagogy (Memoria Press curriculum, Christ-centered teaching). - Pedagogy language in classical summaries highlights elements such as memory work, recitation, and ritual language (Scholé-like restfulness and contemplation are part of the classical tradition, though not explicitly itemized in the public content). The public materials emphasize "teacher-led classroom" rather than a student-centered, project-based approach. - The public content references a classical approach, but explicit public articulation of Socratic seminars, seminars, or debates at the upper levels is not clearly stated in the public materials; Nor is there a strong public articulation of a Scholé rhythm (restful contemplation days) beyond the broader classical framing.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: teacher-led classroom, Memoria Press classical curriculum, classical formation, rhetoric training, memory/recitation, structured governance of learning. - Negative keywords found: explicit mentions of experiential learning, project-based learning, or student-directed learning are not present publicly; however, the lack of explicit Socratic/seminar language in public pages is noted as a missing element from the classical pedagogy fingerprint. - The lexicon identifies "Socratic seminars, oratory, etc." as hallmark pedagogical features; absence from public site content places this category as not fully aligning with the idealized Socratic/seminar pedagogy.

Why this rating - The school strongly adopts classical pedagogy markers (teacher-led, classical curriculum, memorization-oriented pedagogy). However, explicit public statements about Socratic inquiry, seminars, debates, and Scholé days are not clearly documented on-site, so it cannot be certified as fully CLASSICAL in Pedagogy based on public materials alone.

Notes on sources: Headmaster's Welcome language describing a teacher-led, classically framed classroom.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty are framed as the living curriculum and core part of the school; a teacher-led culture and a focus on virtue and mastery are present in the public materials. The Headmaster and public statements emphasize strong teacher leadership and classical formation. - The public materials describe "well-equipped, classically-minded, Christ-following teachers" and a "teacher-led classroom," suggesting a culture of exemplary teachers and a mentorship model. - The presence of a defined Headmaster and "character formation" messaging aligns with the classical faculty profile (living curriculum, portrait of what a teacher should be).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture. - Negative keywords found: none present in public materials.

Why this rating - The public content frames faculty as central to the school's classical mission (living curriculum, teacher-led, Christ-centered). This aligns with CLASSICAL indicators for the Faculty category.

Notes on sources: The "Headmaster's Welcome" and admissions language emphasize the teacher-as-core to the school's operation.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents as co-teachers and primary participants in formation; "Nurture & Mold" language highlights home-school alignment and parental involvement. - Ad-

missions content invites parents to connect, visit, and participate in community life; there are references to community and family engagement (e.g., “Join the Community”). - Public content indicates that the school seeks to educate and involve parents through gatherings and communications about classical education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, open campus/visits, family involvement, community emphasis. - Negative keywords found: None of the typical consumer-language signals or minimal-parent-involvement signals appear; in fact, the content emphasizes parental collaboration.

Why this rating - The school presents a strong parental-partnership model and parent-formation activities in its public materials, aligning with CLASSICAL indicators for category 6.

Notes on sources: Admissions pages and the “Nurture & Mold” phrasing illustrate parent collaboration and community orientation.

What Would Move the Needle

- Make explicit in public materials any Socratic Seminar and upper-school debate/moot court formats to satisfy the Pedagogy criterion more clearly (Element 4). If present, publicly document concrete examples of Socratic dialogue and seminars in upper grades, emphasizing the classical method alongside memorization and teacher-led instruction.
- Publicly foreground a Scholé/restful-learning cadence (e.g., occasional contemplative days, memory work rhythms, and structured contemplative moments) to strengthen the Pedagogy narrative per the classical rubric.

If these needle-moving measures are implemented and clearly articulated on the site, Element 4 would move from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL, reinforcing an overall CLASSICAL profile for the school.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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